



Using wood ant acid for cleaning feathers is called "anting."

Ant defenders

When wood ants feel their nest is threatened, they tuck their abdomens between their legs and spray out **jets of acid** at their attacker. Some sneaky birds get wood ants to spray their feathers on purpose to get rid of itchy mites.

Wood ants often eat other bugs, such as caterpillars.

Wood ant

Worker ants

Larvae